

Message ID	<CAG=V=azMo=N416gZsviD-r+_k=MV8Xjr-sGj6eyJLfDEX7Udqq@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Natalie Ogilvie-Watkins [REDACTED]"
To	<elections@aacounty.org>
Cc	[REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Mon, Jan 5, 2026 at 03:52 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Good afternoon:polling question..
Thread Subject	Good afternoon:polling question..
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Good afternoon! I am a voter in AACo and wanted to start by saying thank you all for everything you do. You all have maintained the integrity our elections and I greatly appreciate that. I hope you all had a nice holiday! I wanted to bring something to your attention as I know you will consider the reason behind my concern. It has come to my attention that the earligh heights fire department may be used as a polling spot as it was in the 2024 elections? I believe before that time, the Severna Park Library was utilized for the polling spot. I am aware the fire chief, Dave Crawford, is running for County executive, and although I know you all have no intention to have a conflict of interest as you wouldn't have known he would run when the polling location was changed. I ask if this is true, to Please consider returning to the original polling place of the Severna Park Library so voters can be absolutely sure there isn't a conflict of interest. Thank you so much for your time!! - Natalie Ogilvie Watkins Owner & Director [REDACTED]	

Message ID	<CABNa5rpEO6Fq8eg2R35z7jZarhctqsMiYoabQPt=x_VE0gWEuA@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Joan Cole" [REDACTED]
To	<elections@aaacounty.org>
Cc	[REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Mon, Jan 5, 2026 at 08:01 AM (Incoming)
Subject	Concern About 2026 Polling Locations
Thread Subject	Concern About 2026 Polling Locations
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

Dear Anne Arundel County Board of Elections,

Thank you for the work you do to ensure that our elections are fair and safe and to serve our candidates who run in our elections. I understand that your office will be considering proposed voting locations in the coming days, and I would like to express my deep concern, as a voter and candidate in Anne Arundel County, about the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station as a polling location this year. While this location served as a good location in 2024, I believe there could be an appearance of a conflict of interest this year because a member of the fire service at this location is running for office. I believe that it would be in the best interest of our county elections to move the polling location to Severna Park Library, where polling has been held previously.

While the fire station proved to be a useful polling location in 2024, there are other factors to consider in this decision. The Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station is not a county or state owned public facility, which does not align with county and state efforts to prioritize public over privately owned locations. In addition, and more importantly, this could be a very close election determined by a small number of precincts. With the current state of politics in our nation and the common suggestions and conspiracy theories about our elections being rigged, eliminating this location from the equation will take the pressure off what could be perceived as questionable results in the election.

As a voter and a candidate in this upcoming election, I would greatly appreciate your office eliminating this unnecessary issue as a concern.

Thank you for your consideration.

Joan Cole

Joan Cole

Candidate for MD State Delegate - District 31

Message ID	<CAJw_A47JAwUyA6TGjKAYGgphuybVDmeV19v2SK6kVLq=23UqvA@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Carolyn Matthews [REDACTED]"
To	<elections@aacounty.org>
Cc	<info.sbe@maryland.gov> [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Thu, Jan 8, 2026 at 02:17 PM (Incoming)
Subject	2026 voting location Severna Park
Thread Subject	2026 voting location Severna Park
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Good afternoon I understand that today is the day for determining voter locations for the 2026 elections. As the Earleigh Heights fire station is run by Chief Dave Crawford, one of the candidates for county executive, I add my voice to those requesting a move back to the Severna Park library. This move will make for a more transparent process and avoid any appearance of impropriety. Thank you for your consideration of this matter. And thank you for all your hard work to keep our elections safe. Carolyn Matthews	

Message ID	<1435223696.4561501.1767913681741@mail.yahoo.com>
From	"Jessica MacBride" [REDACTED]
To	"elections@aacounty.org" <elections@aacounty.org>
Cc	[REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED] info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Date	Thu, Jan 8, 2026 at 06:08 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Consideration of 2026 Polling Locations
Thread Subject	Consideration of 2026 Polling Locations
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

Dear Members of the Anne Arundel County Board of Elections,

As a voter in Anne Arundel County, I want to begin by sincerely thanking you for the time, care, and dedication you bring to administering our elections. I truly appreciate the work you do to ensure that our voting process remains fair, accessible, and trustworthy.

I understand that you will soon be reviewing polling locations for the 2026 election cycle, and I wanted to share a concern regarding one location used in 2024—the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station. While it served voters well during the last election, I have recently learned that a member of the fire service at that location is planning to run for office in the upcoming cycle. Because of this, I worry there could be an appearance of a conflict of interest, even if none exists.

Given the challenges our elections have faced in recent years related to misinformation and public trust, I believe it would be in the best interest of both the candidates and the electorate to avoid even the perception of impropriety. Returning the polling location to the Severna Park Library for the 2026 cycle would help eliminate any concerns and ensure that the integrity of the process remains beyond question—especially in the event of a close race.

I also appreciate that such a move would align with county and state efforts to prioritize publicly owned facilities as polling locations. My hope is simply to support an election process that inspires confidence and protects all involved.

Thank you again for your continued service to our county and for thoughtfully considering this request.

Respectfully,

Jessica MacBride
Severna Park, MD

Message ID	<CACVDqe+D+Ytv9GCpsbbrVNVa_zyZ-myG1e4dcVO=KeiObVhNg@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Luke Tudball" [REDACTED]
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	[REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Thu, Jan 15, 2026 at 03:41 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Please REject Earleigh Heights Fire Station as a Polling Station this Election Cycle
Thread Subject	Please REject Earleigh Heights Fire Station as a Polling Station this Election Cycle
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing as I am very concerned about the potential use of Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station as a polling location in the forthcoming elections this year. I know that this location has been used as a polling place in past years but this year there is a large cause for concern as the current Fire Chief based at that location is running as a candidate in the County Executive race. While I have no issue with the gentleman running for office, indeed I applaud his willingness to serve, it certainly rings a number of alarm bells that he, and other voters, would be required and asked to vote in his place of work. This is especially true as this is a high profile, county-wide race, and this location has been used for early voting in addition to election day itself. I am aware that this location is larger but it is also, I am led to believe, substantially more expensive than other local locations such as Severna Park Public Library which has also been used as a polling location very successfully in the past.

I am writing to ask that in your deliberations and decision-making for the forthcoming elections you take into account our strong reservations with this location and reject this location as a polling station this cycle. A much better choice would be, as previously mentioned, the Severna Park Public Library and I ask you to select that location instead.

In these challenging times I am aware that your work is difficult and I commend you for the job you do but we must do everything we can to avoid the negative optics surrounding the elections which include being very thoughtful about conflict of interest, implied bias, and unfair influence. Once again, I have no issue whatsoever with the Fire Chief running for office, but I do not believe it is fair or right for the Board of Elections to expect us to cast our votes at his place of work where he could have an outsized influence on proceedings.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours

Luke Tudball



Message ID	<SA0PR20MB3310807B1F02CB62AC7BD5E2E08CA@SA0PR20MB3310.namprd20.p rod.outlook.com>
From	"Dana Schallheim" [REDACTED]
To	"info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	[REDACTED] "elections@aacounty.org" <elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Thu, Jan 15, 2026 at 03:36 PM (Incoming)
Subject	No Polling Place at Earleigh Heights Fire Station
Thread Subject	No Polling Place at Earleigh Heights Fire Station
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

Hi Mr. Demaris,

I am writing to ask that the SP Library be used as a polling place in lieu of the fire station to avoid even the smallest semblance of conflict interest between the fire station and a candidate who has strong ties with the fire station.

During this time of deep uncertainty please make the right decision and choose only the most neutral of locations.

Best,
Dana

Message ID	<CAJw_A47PKOz+WOU=ryXERqKTP26jW02xpFaU8=GTbQLNhLdXxg@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Carolyn Matthews [REDACTED]"
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Date	Thu, Jan 15, 2026 at 03:43 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Severna park polling place
Thread Subject	Severna park polling place
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

I am writing to express my concern about using the Earleigh Heights VFD as a voting location for the 2026 elections.

As the fire station is run by Chief Dave Crawford, one of the candidates for county executive, I add my voice to those requesting a move back to the Severna Park library. This move will make for a more transparent process and avoid any appearance of impropriety. While I understand that the size of the building and the traffic pattern at the library has been a concern, I believe the impartiality of the place is more important.

I wrote to the county board regarding my concerns, and their answer was that it is no different from using county property if an incumbent were running - it is still the candidate's home turf. If we were planning to hold the elections at the County HQ building, I would agree. But I think the library is sufficiently removed from an official's day-to-day business to make that analogy a stretch.

There is no accusation or suspicion about Mr. Crawford's intentions in this election. It is not about any individual. The request to move is simply a good government caution to keep public trust in an election.

Thank you for your consideration of this matter. And thank you for all your hard work to keep our elections safe.

Carolyn Matthews
Anne Arundel County resident

Message ID	<658721072.1207657.1768582584966@mail.yahoo.com>
From	"Louis Biondi" [REDACTED]
To	"info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	"elections@aacounty.org" <elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Fri, Jan 16, 2026 at 11:56 AM (Incoming)
Subject	Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station
Thread Subject	Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

I would like to voice my objection to using the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station as a polling place in the upcoming election cycle. Given the fact that a senior member of the EHVFS is running in the upcoming election, I see a definite possibility that some voters may see this as a potential conflict of interest or undue influence over the election. In these days of conspiracy theories, rumor mongering, and outright lying about election results, I believe the State Board of Elections should go out of its way to ensure the appearance of propriety and choose an alternative polling place.

The Severna Park Branch of the Anne Arundel County Library would be a suitable alternative. My wife and I have voted there many times in the past and found it a convenient and comfortable place to vote.

Thank you for your consideration in this matter.

Louis G. Biondi

Message ID	<1895927199.692041.1768591583409@mail.yahoo.com>
From	"Pmoats3561" [REDACTED]
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Date	Fri, Jan 16, 2026 at 02:26 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Please consider Severna Park Library
Thread Subject	Please consider Severna Park Library
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

Mr. Demarinis,

For many reasons the Severna Park library would be a better polling place compared to Earleigh Heights Vol.Fire Dept. This is because of the quality of the parking lots of each. (Library's much better).

It is also because of traffic flow on E. Earleigh Hts Rd. It is far busier than that on W. McKenzie Rd, in part because of the shopping center that also accesses E. Earleigh Heights.

Please seriously consider moving the polling place back to the library. I feel confident most in-person voters, and poll workers will appreciate it. It may be less expensive as well. Thank you for your consideration. -Pamela Moats



Revised Polling Place Plans

David Garreis -SBE-

Tue, Jan 13, 2026 at 10:12 AM

To: Cyril Komp -SBE-

Cc: Richard Siejack -SBE-

Katherine Berry -SBE-

Morgan Rhoden -SBE-

Melissia Dorsey -SBE-

Rebecca Browder

CJ

Our Board received comments about using the Earleigh Height Volunteer Fire Hall in Severna Park due to the Fire Chief running for County Executive in the Republican Primary.

The State Board of Elections (SBE) approved this site for Early Voting at last month's meeting. The AAC Board previously discussed this matter during our September 2025 and January 2026 meetings. The Board Attorney advised that all candidates must follow the same rules regarding site access. The Attorney also noted that excluding this site would imply that local boards could not use any public buildings if a County Executive were running for re-election, or schools if School Board members were on the ballot.

Anne Arundel County faces significant logistical challenges with the Severna Park Library. The voting room is too small for the required number of election judges, voters, and equipment. Historically, this is one of the busiest early voting sites in the state, yet it lacks adequate parking. Previously, election judges were forced to park at an adjacent nursing home.

In contrast, the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Hall is a long-standing and excellent location. It offers a large room and a substantial parking lot with ample overflow space. This provides more room for electioneers and reduces the safety concerns present at the library. It is also centrally located at the corner of Ritchie Highway with easy access from Route 10, Route 100, and public transit.

To mitigate any concerns, the Board decided we shall contact all candidates in writing to notify them of the laws and guidelines regarding electioneering, access to the polling room, and the posting of signage.

If you have any questions or need further information, please don't hesitate to ask.

David

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